

Today we turn to our third big question. This question can be introduced by an example.

Suppose that in the year 2069 the surviving members of this Introduction to Philosophy class decided to have an Intro to Philosophy reunion, and all gathered in this room. Suppose that they decided to get a group picture taken.

Now imagine that, via some sort of time travel device, I now have that photo, and show it to you. You might ask: Am I one of those people? Which one am I?

It is very natural to assume that these questions must have determinate answers. There must be some fact of the matter about whether one of the people in the photo is you. And, if one is you, there must be some fact of the matter about which one is you.

Let's suppose that this is true: there must be a fact about whether you survive to be
in this picture, and must be a fact about which of the survivors you are.

Then we can ask a question about these facts:

**The survival
question:** What does it
take for for some
person at some other
time to be you?

To introduce our main answers to the survival question, it will be useful to think about a simple, uncontroversial example of survival.

All of you believe that you will wake up tomorrow in your bed. To put the same point another way, all of you believe that the person now sitting in your seat is the same person as — identical to — the person who will wake up in your bed tomorrow morning.

What do we mean when we say that you are identical to that person?

Here it is important to get clear at the outset on one distinction which, if not attended to, can make these questions more confusing than they have to be.

This is the distinction between **numerical** and **qualitative** identity.

To say that x and y are numerically identical is to say that they are literally the same thing — they are one, not two.

To say that x and y things are qualitatively identical is to say that they are exactly resembling — they have just the same properties.

When we say that you are identical to the person who will get out of your bed tomorrow morning, we are not of course saying that you are qualitatively identical to that person. Their hair will be messed up, and they will be wearing different clothes.

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just

one person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow morning in that bed.



**materialist
survival**

A solid red circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the words "soul" and "survival" are written in a white, bold, sans-serif font, stacked vertically.

**soul
survival**



psycho-
logical
survival

**What does it take for
a material thing to
continue to exist
from one moment to
the next?**

**For me to survive,
which material thing
has to continue to
exist?**

Here's one natural answer:

The same parts view

X is the same material object as Y just in case X and Y have the same parts arranged in the same way.

But this is not a promising answer from the point of view of someone who thinks that there is a material component to survival. Can you see why?

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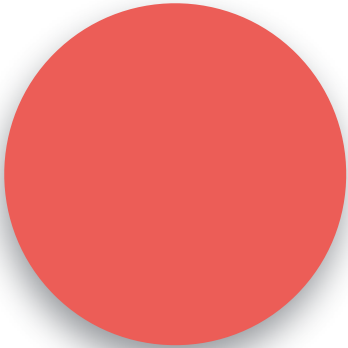
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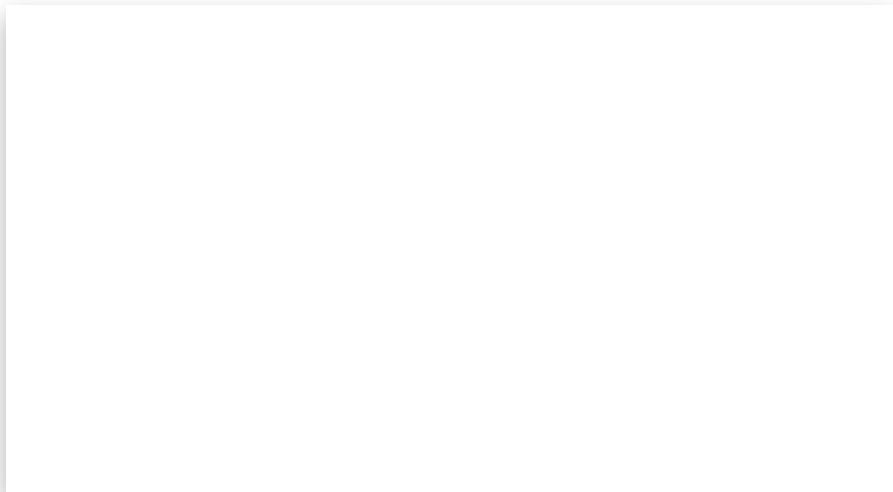
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What does it take for



Materialism:
I am a wholly
material
thing



Simple
dualism: I am
an immaterial
soul

Fusion
dualism: I am
a combination
of a soul
and a body

**Soul
survival:**

X is me just in
case X is the
same immaterial
soul as me

Fusion survival:

X is me just in case X
has the same immaterial
soul as me and is the
same material thing as
me

How should a materialist respond?